LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 34 · October 22, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 34 closes the בכור שאחזו דם sugya: the Gemara decouples it from the parallel תרומה תלויה case — רבי אלעזר vs. רבי יהושע on guarding doubtful terumah (תרומתי/תרומתי, the למסורת/יש אם למקרא showdown) — and paskens הלכה כרבי שמעון דברייתא. Then the new Mishnah, הצורם אוזן בבכור, and the double contradiction with the נגע צרעת kenasa, resolved via גופו/ממונו. Closing: Rav Papa's ויטהר/יטהר (the chasan's nafka mina) and whether the kenasa follows the son.

כל מום · THE DOG-FOOD-ON-THE-EAR LOOPHOLE



1. Without the word כל in 'כל מום לא יהיה בו,' you'd only know you can't blemish the animal yourself. How do you know you can't smear dog food on its ear, unleash a dog, and let it bite the food — and the ear — off?

“Lebowitz: 'So you didn't do anything — the dog did it! Yeah, but you caused it.' תלמוד לומר: כל מום — one mum, and any mum. The Torah covers your Rube Goldberg crime scene.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 34a · שלא יביא דבילה ובצק — the dog-food-on-the-ear case · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 7:19

תרומתי · THE OLDEST SPELLING-VS-PRONUNCIATION FIGHT



2. The Torah writes תרומתי (singular); the baal korei reads תרומותי (plural). Rabbi Elazar: two terumot — go by the pronunciation. Rabbi Yehoshua: one — 'That's how it's spelled. I don't care how it's pronounced.'

“And so the Gemara's great יש אם למקרא או יש אם למסורת debate: is Torah law decided by spelling or pronunciation? The world's oldest spelling-bee controversy.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 34a · ואני הנה נתתי לך את משמרת תרומתי — kri or ketiv? · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 16:39

אין בישול אחר בישול · THE SWISS FINISHING-SCHOOL CHANUKAH CANDLES



3. Swiss finishing schools once cooked everything in wartime grease of neveila fat, pig fat, and butter. The girls made candles from the leftover fatty butter — and asked: can you light נר חנוכה with them?

“Psak: אסור — lighting them recooks the butter: fresh בישול בשר בחלב. The defense: 'מצוות לאו ליהנות ניתנו' — your menorah, courtesy of a treif pot.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 34a · the מחמץ-אחר-מחמץ sugya — can you re-cook what's already cooked? · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 11:19

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שמא יבוא אליהו · THE MASHIACH-ERA CUSTOMER-SERVICE PLAN



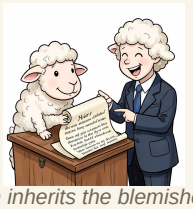
4. Two barrels of terumah — one definitely tamei, you just don't know which. Rabbi Elazar: guard the doubtful one anyway — it's still ראויה לך*.' Why?* שמא יבוא אליהו ויטהרנה*.*

“Elefant: Eliyahu will tell us which bread the sheretz touched — 'I have news for you' — and the other we'll know is tahor. Your halachic exit strategy: wait for Eliyahu to do the forensics.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 34a · שמא יבוא אליהו ויטהרנה — הא נמי ראויה היא · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 19:23

קנסו בנו אחריו · THE ESTATE-PLANNING LOOPHOLE



5. A man clips his bekhor's ear and dies. His son inherits the blemished animal: 'It's a bekhor baal mum now — I'm allowed to shecht it. I didn't do anything wrong!'

“The Gemara: או דלמא לממוניה קנסו רבנן והא לידידיה קנסו רבנן והא איתיה? Answer, via shemitah: לבריה לא קנסו, לידידיה קנסו רבנן. The fine dies with dad — the loophole works.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 34b · צורם אוזן בבכור ומת — does the kenasa outlive dad? · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 44:55

חתן שנראה בו נגע · EVEN TZARAAS RESPECTS THE HONEYMOON



6. Rav Papa: יטהר *or* ויטהר *— does the first nega clear when a second appears, or only when the second is cured? The Gemara:* למאי נפ"ק מינה*? Either way he's a metzora!*

“The one real case: לחתן שנראה בו נגע. A groom who breaks out during sheva brachot gets נותנין לו שבעה ימים — the kohen holds off, not wanting to disturb him being משמח his wife. Even tzaraas respects the honeymoon.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 34b · לחתן שנראה בו נגע — the seven-day honeymoon pass · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 42:33